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# In Search of Utpaladeva's Lost *Vivṛti* on the Pratyabhijñā Treatise: A Report on the Latest Discoveries (with the *Vivṛti* on the End of Chapter 1.8)

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**Abstract** The *Īśvarapratyabhijñā* treatise—an important philosophical text composed in Kashmir in the 10th century CE by the Śaiva nondualist Utpaladeva—remains partly unavailable to date: a crucial component of this work, namely the detailed commentary (*Vivṛti* or *Ṭīkā*) in which Utpaladeva explained his own verses, is considered as almost entirely lost, since only a small part of it has been preserved in a single, very incomplete manuscript remarkably edited and translated by Raffaele Torella. However, our knowledge of the *Vivṛti* is quickly expanding: many additional fragments have recently come to light. The article gives an overview of these new findings while highlighting the most interesting of them, i.e. the discovery of the lengthiest *Vivṛti* fragment known to date in the margins of a manuscript containing Abhinavagupta's *Vivṛtivimarśinī*. It also provides an edition and translation of the beginning of this fragment.

**Keywords** Utpaladeva · Pratyabhijñā · Nondual Śaivism · Consciousness · Idealism · Fragments

Many thanks are due to Chetan Pandey, whose commendable endeavour to make photographs of various manuscripts preserved in Jammu and Kashmir and whose generosity in sharing these photographs with the scholarly community have led to the most interesting discovery mentioned in this article (see below, fn. 21); to Alexis Sanderson, among countless reasons for helping me identify the scribe of a manuscript (see below, fn. 12); and to Vincent Eltschinger, for carefully reading a previous version of this paper and for providing insightful remarks.

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## The Only Known *Vivṛti* Manuscript: An Invaluable Yet Very Incomplete Source

Although we now have at our disposal manuscripts and editions of several important commentaries on Utpaladeva's *Stanzas on the Recognition of the Lord* (ĪPK)—i.e. Utpaladeva's own short explanation or *Vṛtti*, and Abhinavagupta's two lengthy commentaries, the ĪPV and ĪPVV, to date no complete manuscript has come to light of what must have been the most crucial exegetical layer of this work,[1] namely Utpaladeva's own detailed commentary (*Vivṛti* or *Ṭīkā*). However, the latter is not entirely unknown to us, mostly thanks to the groundbreaking studies of Raffaele Torella, who has published in a remarkable series of articles an edition and English translation of the only *Vivṛti* manuscript thus far known.[2] Unfortunately this manuscript (D), now preserved in the National Archives of India, is very incomplete: it only covers 13 verses out of the treatise's 190 *kārikā*s (see below, Appendix).

## Newly Discovered *Vivṛti* Fragments in Marginal Annotations of ĪPV Manuscripts

We can of course try and make up for the loss of the greater part of the *Vivṛti* by examining Abhinavagupta's ĪPVV, which mainly comments on Utpaladeva's lost work. Although usually Abhinavagupta only mentions one (or at best a few) of the words belonging to the passages that he chooses to explain, and although he does not comment on every single sentence in the *Vivṛti*, his *pratīka*s, explanations and paraphrases can often help reconstruct the structure of Utpaladeva's reasonings, which proves particularly useful whenever Utpaladeva's lost *Vivṛti* obviously expounded on matters that are barely touched upon or even left untold in the verses and *Vṛtti*.[3] Besides, Abhinavagupta sometimes provides somewhat lengthier quotations, thus enabling us to retrieve whole sentences or verses from the *Vivṛti*.[4] However, the latter

[1] On the importance of the *Vivṛti* see Torella (2014). Many elements in the known *Vivṛti* fragments and Abhinavagupta's ĪPVV show that Utpaladeva tackled in his *Vivṛti* a number of philosophical issues that his verses and concise *Vṛtti* do not mention or barely allude to (for a few examples of such points, see fn. 3 below). Besides, from the *Vivṛti* fragments recovered so far it has become obvious that contrary to what was long surmised by most historians of Indian philosophy, Abhinavagupta, although a particularly brilliant commentator, was not the main innovative force in the Pratyabhijñā tradition: as first pointed out by Raffaele Torella, it was rather Utpaladeva who developed new ideas, the most complete exposition of which was to be found in the *Vivṛti.*

[2] See Torella (1988, 2011a, b, c, d, 2012).

[3] For cases where only the ĪPVV mentions an idea that is not found in the verses, *Vṛtti* or ĪPV (and where Utpaladeva's reasoning as explained in the verses and *Vṛtti* would hardly seem to make sense without Abhinavagupta's paraphrase of the *Vivṛti*) see e.g. Ratié (2011a, pp. 735–737) (on the soteriological power of inferential reasonings); Ratié (2011b, pp. 491–495) (on the impossibility of inferring the existence of a reality external to consciousness) or Ratié (2014) (on Utpaladeva's interpretation of the *satkāryavāda*).

[4] Sometimes such quotations are fairly obvious and occur precisely where we might expect to find them (see e.g. the *Vivṛti maṅgala*-verse quoted in full in ĪPVV, vol. I, p. 3, as already noted in Sanderson 2001, fn. 47, p. 37). In some instances, however, they can prove more difficult to identify. Thus in ĪPV on ĪPK 1.4.3 (a verse that occurs towards the middle of the first part of the treatise), Abhinavagupta quotes in full the first concluding verse of the *Vivṛti* without explaining what the verse is and where it comes from, whereas while commenting on the end of the *Vivṛti* in his ĪPVV, he only gives the first two words (corrupted in the ĪPVV edition) of this verse (see Ratié 2015, fn. 4, pp. 225–226).

are exceptions, and Abhinavagupta's ĪPVV, which is a difficult work,[5] can provide precious clues as to what the gist of a given *Vivṛti* passage may have been, but does not permit by itself any reliable reconstruction of the text on which it comments.

It should be noted, however, that in recent years a number of hitherto unknown *Vivṛti* fragments have come to light, although they were not found in some newly identified manuscript of Utpaladeva's detailed commentary, but in annotations written in the margins of other texts commenting on the Pratyabhijñā treatise. Thus a diplomatic edition of a few brief *Vivṛti* fragments found in the margins of a *Vṛtti* manuscript was recently published (see Kawajiri 2015),[6] and a number of lengthier fragments copied in the margins of several ĪPV manuscripts are currently being edited and translated (see Ratié 2015, forthcoming a, b).

Most of the marginal annotations in which these fragments are preserved happen to be quotations, but they are not only from Utpaladeva's lost work—far from that. In ĪPV manuscripts, their sources include other Śaiva texts (Utpaladeva's *Vṛtti* and most of all Abhinavagupta's ĪPVV, although other Śaiva works appear as well, particularly Somānanda's *Śivadṛṣṭi* and Utpaladeva's commentary thereon). Besides, in keeping with the overall strategy of Utpaladeva's treatise (which is mainly concerned with philosophical debates involving various non-Śaiva traditions), these annotations often quote from non-Śaiva works that are both Brahmanical (e.g. Bhartṛhari's *Vākyapadīya* or Jayanta's *Nyāyamañjarī*) and Buddhist (e.g. Dharmakīrti's *Pramāṇavārttika*, *Pramāṇavārttikasvavṛtti* and *Sambandhaparīkṣā*).

Very little is known about the origin, transmission, date and purpose of these annotations.[7] Given that the very same *Vivṛti* passages recur in the margins of many ĪPV manuscripts, it seems highly probable that many of these annotations were copied from similar annotations in earlier ĪPV manuscripts rather than directly borrowed from one or several *Vivṛti* manuscript(s).[8] Nonetheless, among the ĪPV

[5] No full translation of it has ever been given in any European language, and the only edition ever published often presents a corrupted text.

[6] The article deals with "new fragments" from p. 93 to p. 99, but these fragments include quotations from other works such as the ĪPVV and ĪPV, and the passages that can be safely ascribed to the *Vivṛti* are too brief to be considered here.

[7] In this respect one can only deplore the paucity of studies on marginalia in South Asia: to my knowledge the only work entirely devoted to this topic is an unpublished PhD dissertation (Formigatti 2011) that provides a very careful and insightful analysis of some marginal annotations in Kashmirian manuscripts, including ĪPV ones. Unfortunately it makes no mention of *Vivṛti* fragments, although at least one of the manuscripts examined (i.e. the one labelled Ś7 by C. Formigatti) contains quotations from Utpaladeva's detailed auto-commentary (see Ratié forthcoming b). The reason for this is that due to the length of the ĪPV, C. Formigatti could not take into account all the marginalia in these manuscripts and therefore chose to confine his research to the annotations on the first chapter, which seem to be devoid of such quotations.

[8] One should note in this connection that the pandits from the Śrinagar Research Department who edited the ĪPVV in the Kashmir Series of Texts and Studies chose to reproduce the annotations in the margins of the manuscripts at their disposal (some of which happened to contain short *Vivṛti* fragments) in the footnotes of their edition, although they did not deem it necessary to explain where the text of their footnotes originally came from. This decision might have seemed most natural to them precisely because as far as the manuscript tradition was concerned, it was customary to copy marginalia along with the main text.

manuscripts of my knowledge, S3, which appears to be by far the oldest,[9] contains most of the *Vivṛti* fragments found in later manuscripts, yet it lacks a number of quotations found in other manuscripts[10] and it cannot be considered as their single source. Besides, even when a manuscript can be dated fairly accurately thanks to the informations contained in its colophon (which is rare in the case of the manuscripts I have consulted), it is often difficult to determine whether the same scribe copied both the main text and the annotations, or whether the latter are a later addition.

In any case it is beyond doubt that those who copied these annotations were mostly learned men who claimed to understand both the content of the quotations and that of the main text. In this connection it might not be out of place to say a few more words of S3, the oldest annotated ĪPV manuscript of my knowledge, which must have been copied in the seventeenth century,[11] and in which, as far as I can judge, the marginal annotations and the main text are very likely to be in the same hand. In the colophon, the scribe identifies himself as Rājānaka Śaṅkarakaṇṭha, and this character was in all likelihood the father of Rājānaka Ratnakaṇṭha,[12] a renowned Śaiva author who presents himself in his works as the son of Rājānaka Śaṅkarakaṇṭha, who must have been active around 1680,[13] and who, as already noted by Marc Aurel Stein, was famous not only for composing works of his own, but also for his remarkable abilities as a manuscript copyist.[14] It is also very likely

[9] See below.

[10] See Ratié (2015, fn. 8, p. 227), for a list of passages from the fragment edited by Raffaele Torella that are found in some ĪPV manuscripts but do not occur in S3.

[11] Besides the fact that the scribe's name is identical to that of the father of a well-known seventeenth century Kashmirian author (see below), see the rather recent, hand-written Sanskrit note in *devanāgarī* script attached to the beginning of the manuscript, which specifies that the person who copied it, namely Śaṅkarakaṇṭha, "lived in Kashmir during the reign of Shah Jahan" (*śāhajahānarājye kāśmīreṣu jīvitavān āsīt*), and which adds that "there is no other manuscript older than this manuscript" (*prater asyā prācīnā nānyā kācana pratir vidyate*), by which it is probably meant that the library contains no older manuscript of the Pratyabhijñā treatise.

[12] I thank Alexis Sanderson for first drawing my attention to the fact that a Rājānaka Śaṅkarakaṇṭha known to him "as the author of a *Bhairavastotra* transmitted in some manuscripts of the *Kalādīkṣāpaddhati* was the father of the well-known scholar Rājānaka Ratnakaṇṭha, who wrote his commentary on the *Stutikusumāñjali* of Jagaddhara according to its initial and final verses (which also tell us that Śaṅkarakaṇṭha was his father) from Śaka 1602 [AD 1680] to Vikrama 1738 [AD 1681] during the reign of Aurangzeb (*avaraṅgamahīpāle kṛtsnāṃ śāsati medinīm*). So the date proposed on the slip may well be right" (Personal written communication, 2008). The "slip" referred to here is the hand-written note (see above, fn. 11) according to which Śaṅkarakaṇṭha lived during Shah Jahan's reign.

[13] On Ratnakaṇṭha, his dates and works, and the name of his father, see Hanneder et al. (2013, pp. 12–20).

[14] See Stein (1900, pp. 46–47 and fn. 6). M.A. Stein remarks that as he writes his translation of the *Rājataraṅgiṇī*, the memory of Ratnakaṇṭha "still lives in Kaśmīr Paṇḍit tradition as that of a great scholar and very fast writer" capable of copying manuscripts at a particularly impressive rate; the author also mentions "the considerable number of manuscripts written by him which are still extant in Kaśmīrian libraries both in and outside the valley", as well as Ratnakaṇṭha's very distinctive handwriting and the difficulty of deciphering it. See also Witzel (1994, p. 13).

that this latter character is none other than the Ratnakaṇṭha whom Bhāskarakaṇṭha —the author of the commentary on Abhinavagupta's ĪPV known as the *Bhāskarī*— mentions as his master.[15] This is one of the many clues showing that those who copied such annotated *śāradā* manuscripts were not mere scribes but pandits who endeavoured to understand and teach the content of the texts that they copied. It also seems to indicate that by the seventeenth century, gaining access to Utpaladeva's *Vivṛti* (if only in the form of the fragments found in some annotated ĪPV manuscripts) was already difficult, even for those who were engaged in an in-depth study of Abhinavagupta's commentaries: thus Bhāskarakaṇṭha, whose master's father was probably the person who copied many of the fragments in manuscript S3, misunderstands passages of Abhinavagupta's ĪPV that he could not have misinterpreted had he known Utpaladeva's *Vivṛti* on these passages,[16] and it seems highly likely that he had no complete manuscript of the *Vivṛti* at his disposal.

[15] See Sanderson (2007, p. 422).

[16] A striking example (among several others) is that of Bhāskarakaṇṭha's misunderstanding of an ĪPV passage dealing with the Buddhist controversy over the existence of other conscious streams. Thus in the *Vivṛti* fragment on ĪPK 1.5.4–5 edited and translated in Ratié (2015), the Buddhist Vijñānavādin portrayed by Utpaladeva argues that although we can have no direct perception of other people's consciousness, we can *infer* that the others are also conscious beings from the fact that when we talk, we experience in ourselves that our speech is invariably preceded by a conscious will to speak, so that if the others speak, they too must have had a conscious will to speak and are therefore conscious beings. The Vijñānavādin must nonetheless face the following objection on the part of his Sautrāntika rival: it is true that in us, the thought "I want to speak" invariably occurs before the thought "I am speaking", but when it comes to other individuals whose actions I might witness, what the Vijñānavādin needs (and fails) to establish in order to prove that they are indeed conscious entities is rather the invariable connection between the thought "*(s)he* is speaking" occurring in me and a previous thought "*I* want to speak" that may have occurred in the other. The Vijñānavādin therefore endeavours to show that we do experience in ourselves the causal connection between these two thoughts ("*I* want to speak" and "*(s)he* is speaking"), and to that end, he argues that whenever we want to talk, we also want to be heard by others, which means that we are always somehow aware of the causal link between our own subjective intention "*I* want to speak" and its result in other consciousnesses, which takes the objective form "*(s)he* is speaking". The Sautrāntika replies that we do not experience such an invariable concomitance, since sometimes we wish in vain to be heard by others, and sometimes we are heard by others despite our desire not to be heard. Abhinavagupta sums up this response by the Sautrāntika in the following way in ĪPV, vol. I, p. 173: *na ca vicchinno'py ābhāsa utpadyatām iti tadabhisandhānāt* tadutpattir niyatā tatsadbhāve'py anutpattes tadabhāve cotpatteḥ.* [* *tadabhisandhānāt* conj., see Ratié 2011, fn. 59, p. 595: *tadanusandhānāt* Ed.] "And this [i.e. the thought 'he is speaking' occurring in someone else hearing me speak] does not necessarily arise thanks to [my] intention of [speaking that takes the form] 'may a manifestation [of my speech] arise [in the other's consciousness] while being separated [from the other's subjectivity, i.e. in the form: '*he* is speaking']; because even when there is such [an intention to be heard on my part, sometimes the thought 'he is speaking'] does not arise [in others while I speak], and [sometimes] this [thought] arises [in them] whereas there is no such [intention on my part]!" Now, according to Bhāskarakaṇṭha, the Vijñānavādin's argument criticized here is quite different and amounts to saying that my will "I want *someone else* to speak" necessarily makes the other conscious being speak, so that the Sautrāntika has no difficulty showing that this claim is absurd because sometimes we want someone else to talk and are disappointed, and sometimes other people talk even if we are absent and have not wished them to talk. See *Bhāskarī*, vol. I, pp. 218–219: *tatsadbhāve'pi—avicchinnābhāsāśrayānumātṛsadbhāve'py asya—vicchinnābhāsasyānutpatteḥ—utpādābhāvāt. na hi paravyāhārasya tatrāvaśyambhāva iti bhāvaḥ. tadabhāve ca—anumātrabhāve ca, na hy anumātṛsannidhāv eva paro vyāharatīti bhāvaḥ.* "[The passage beginning with] *tadsadbhāve'pi* [means the following]: because although there is a subject inferring [the existence of others,] in whom a manifestation that is not separated [from his own subjectivity] rests [in the form 'I want the other to speak'], there is no 'arising of this', [i.e.] of the separated manifestation ['he is speaking']. For in the case [where the inferring subject is present], the other's speech does not necessarily occur—this is the implicit idea; and 'in his absence'—[i.e.] in the absence of the inferring subject, [there is no

As for the origin of the quotations given in the annotations, it is sometimes specified,[17] but unfortunately in most cases it is left untold. It is possible, however, to establish that a given manuscript contains genuine quotations from the *Vivṛti* in its margins by systematically comparing the marginalia pertaining to the part of the treatise covered by the *Vivṛti* incomplete *codex unicus* with Raffaele Torella's edition of the latter,[18] and of course, by comparing these marginal annotations with the order of the *pratīka*s in the ĪPVV and with Abhinavagupta's explanations.

So far this ongoing investigation has led to recover fragments of Utpaladeva's *Vivṛti* on ĪPK 1.3.5 and 1.5.4–1.5.9. It should be pointed out that this is a very limited improvement on Raffaele Torella's studies, both because the fragments recently found in the margins of ĪPV manuscripts cover very few verses (see below, Appendix) and because the recovered text has numerous lacunae, as is obvious from a comparison with Abhinavagupta's commentary. Besides, although the collation and study of these margins is far from being completed,[19] it is worth noting that so far I could not find any *Vivṛti* fragment before verse 1.3.5 or after verse 1.5.9. In other words, although for now this is only a working hypothesis, it seems more and more likely that all the fragments recently found in ĪPV manuscripts originally came from a single *Vivṛti* manuscript *that was already fragmentary by the time the annotations on Abhinavagupta's text were first made*. This manuscript must have contained the passage preserved in the *Vivṛti* codex unicus edited by Raffaele Torella, as well as a few additional folios that used to come immediately before and after what now remains of the manuscript preserved in Delhi.

Footnote 16 continued
necessary absence of the other's speech], for it is not only in the presence of the inferring subject that the other speaks—this [too] is the implicit meaning." However, the corresponding *Vivṛti* passage is clearly incompatible with this interpretation, and explicitly states that the Sautrāntika's argument is about showing how *sometimes we want in vain to be perceived by others, and sometimes we wish to no avail that they did not perceive us*. See the text edited in Ratié (2015, pp. 239–240): *na ca paro māṃ paśyatv ity abhisandhānāt parasantāne vicchinnavyāhārādyavabhāsotpattir yuktā, tathābhisandhāne mā drākṣīd iti vā viparītābhisandhāne tadanutpattiprasaṅgāt.* "Moreover, it is not [true] that the arising in some other [conscious] stream of a manifestation of [my action of] e.g. speaking separated [from that subject, i.e. taking the form '*he* is speaking',] is [only] possible due to the [previous] intention [in my own conscious stream] 'may the other perceive me' (*na… paro māṃ paśyatu*); because whether [I have] such an intention [of being perceived] or whether [I have] the contrary intention 'may [the other] not perceive [me]', [sometimes] no arising of the [manifestation 'he is acting, speaking, etc.'] ensues [in the other]."

[17] Some of the *Vivṛti* quotations end with *iti ṭīkāyām* or *iti ṭīkākāraḥ*; some are preceded by *tad āha ṭīkākāraḥ* or *iti darśayati vivṛtikāraḥ.*

[18] See Ratié (2015) for a list of marginal annotations quoting passages already known from R. Torella's edition of the *Vivṛti* codex unicus.

[19] I discovered for the first time a *Vivṛti* fragment of some length in the margins of an ĪPV manuscript in January 2012; yet I am still in the process of collating margins of ĪPV manuscripts, in part because identifying the various sources of these quotations can be time-consuming (electronic texts are of course immensely helpful in this regard, but their usefulness remains somewhat limited due to the many variants found in the marginalia; and when a given annotation cannot be traced back to some already known work, one still has to find evidence showing that it must be a *Vivṛti* fragment rather than a quotation from some other lost work, or even a mere gloss of the ĪPV). Besides, since 2012 I had the opportunity to consult many ĪPV manuscripts (more than 40) with or without annotations, and the list of annotated ĪPV manuscripts containing *Vivṛti* fragments keeps growing: to date I know eight of them (see Ratié forthcoming a, Appendix for detailed references) and in all likelihood more such manuscripts will come to light in the coming years.

If this hypothesis turns out to be valid, this is bad news for those who hope to retrieve more of Utpaladeva's lost text, since it means that the source constituted by these annotated ĪPV manuscripts has now run dry. However, another important source has most recently come to light—one that might turn out to be much richer than the annotations in ĪPV manuscripts discovered so far.

## Another Discovery in the Margins of an ĪPVV Manuscript: The Longest *Vivṛti* Fragment Known to Date?

The ĪPV is not the only commentary on the Pratyabhijñā treatise that is likely to have been studied by pandits liable to annotate their copies with extracts from the *Vivṛti*. Yohei Kawajiri has shown that at least one *Vṛtti* manuscript bears short fragments of Utpaladeva's lost text, and in fact the commentary that is most likely to contain *Vivṛti* passages, or even the complete work, is rather the ĪPVV: after all, whereas the ĪPV is mainly concerned with providing a synthetic explanation of the verses, the ĪPVV primarily comments on the *Vivṛti*, and we might expect the *Vivṛti* to have been copied together with Abhinavagupta's commentary on it.

Unfortunately, to date no ĪPVV manuscript containing the *mūla*-text has been found, and it is striking in this regard that in the *Vivṛti* manuscript studied by Raffaele Torella, the *Vivṛti* was not copied along with the ĪPVV, but rather, with the two shorter commentaries, namely Utpaladeva's *Vṛtti* and Abhinavagupta's ĪPV. Of course, one can only hope that a manuscript containing both the *Vivṛti* and ĪPVV will come to light at some point, but unfortunately ĪPVV manuscripts are far less common than ĪPV ones, probably due to the unusual length of the former;[20] they are very often incomplete, and almost never annotated—again, probably because annotating such a lengthy text must have appeared as a particularly tedious task when one could annotate shorter commentaries on the Pratyabhijñā treatise.

However, thanks to Chetan Pandey[21] I have recently become aware of at least one ĪPVV manuscript that bears annotations. This manuscript (J11), preserved in Jammu and written in *devanāgarī* script, is obviously a late copy of an earlier *śāradā* manuscript. It has no colophon; it is complete at the beginning and end;[22] the scribe carefully indicates any illegible *akṣara* in the manuscript that he was copying by using dots;[23] and the manuscript bears no annotations at all on hundreds of folios

[20] The ĪPVV as edited in the Kashmir Series of Texts and Studies is comprised of 1176 pages.

[21] Chetan Pandey kindly provided the photographs of J11; he also drew my attention to this manuscript for which I could find no reference in Stein (1894), Patkar (1970–1984) and Shastri and Mishra (2004) (as shown by Chetan Pandey's systematic efforts to photograph the manuscript collection in the Sri Ranbir Institute, a number of manuscripts preserved there remain uncatalogued).

[22] In fact folios 1A–10A do not contain the ĪPVV but Utpaladeva's verses and *Vṛtti*; then the manuscript numbering starts back to 1 (although both the preliminary part and the rest were obviously copied by the same hand), and after a series of salutations to deities it immediately gives the first introductory verse of the ĪPVV.

[23] This might seem odd at first sight given the oft-quoted remarks in Bühler (1877) on the Kashmirian propensity to "cook" *devanāgarī* manuscripts. G. Bühler notes that the latter are recent in the valley at the time of his report (ibid., p. 33: "I was told that these characters had come into more general use during the last thirty years only"); and while as noted above, *śāradā* manuscripts were most often copied by pandits,

(except for occasional short corrections of omissions in the main text). But from folio 202A to folio 242B, the appearance of the manuscript abruptly changes: the margins suddenly get crowded with annotations—and these contain parts of Utpaladeva's lost commentary.

In several respects these annotations are very different from those described above: as already noted, the *Vivṛti* fragments thus far found in the margins of ĪPV manuscripts are cited among numerous quotations of other works; they are usually rather short (their length before the occurrence of a lacuna varies from a few sentences to the equivalent of a single edited page in a modern book); and they all belong to a portion of the treatise extending from 1.3.5 to 1.5.9. In the case of J11, however, the *Vivṛti* passages given in the margins do not seem to be interrupted by quotations of other texts besides the *Vṛtti* (regularly quoted at the beginning of the commentary on each verse). More importantly, although I have not finished yet editing the text of the margins, so that in this case as well as in that of the ĪPV manuscripts, I can only provide provisional conclusions, it seems that contrary to the case of the fragments in the margins of ĪPV manuscripts, the text of the *Vivṛti* found here is relatively free of lacunae. Below is given as a sample the beginning of the annotations in J11 (they start towards the end of the commentary on ĪPK 1.8.10, and they are given here up to the end of the *Vivṛti* on ĪPK 1.8.11—that is to say, up to the end of the *Jñānādhikāra*). Now, what is perhaps most striking about the passage edited here is that not a single *pratīka* from Abhinavagupta's ĪPVV is lacking. This means that the commentary on ĪPK 1.8.11 is in all probability complete (by way of contrast, it should be kept in mind that not a single fragment found in the margins of an ĪPV manuscript covers Utpaladeva's commentary on a whole verse). And the text given below has been extracted from the margins of three pages; but the marginal annotations made on seventy-six other pages are still awaiting an edition and translation. The annotations run up to ĪPK 2.3.8, that is, they cover twenty-five verses—almost twice as many as the verses commented upon in the *Vivṛti* codex unicus (see Appendix below). To sum up, this could be the longest *Vivṛti* fragment ever found to date, and one that mainly bears on a section of the treatise (the *Kriyādhikāra*) of which no fragment was known so far.

Footnote 23 continued

G. Bühler further remarks that *devanāgarī* manuscripts are usually the work of professional scribes: "the difficulty which the pandits have in reading printed *devanāgarī* texts shows that even now the character is little used by them. All *devanāgarī* MSS. are written by professional scribes, the *bāch-bhaṭṭa*s, and are, for this reason, even if they have been afterwards corrected by pandits, less trustworthy than even *śāradā* paper manuscripts." The reports adds that "as the *devanāgarī* manuscripts are mostly prepared for the market, they are also not unfrequently 'cooked', i.e. the lacunae and defects in the original are filled in according to the fancy of the Pandit who corrects them. This most objectionable habit prevails in Kaśmīr to a very great extent, perhaps to a greater extent than in India proper." However, this practice might not have been as widespread as G. Bühler presents it, and many *devanāgarī* manuscripts clearly indicate the lacunae of the original (cf. Witzel 1994, p. 15), as J11 does. Besides, some of the scribes preparing *devanāgarī* manuscripts may have carefully indicated the presence of any *akṣara* that they could not read in the original precisely in order to enable their learned readers to correct (or "cook"…) the problematic passages.

## The Doctrinal Context and Content of the *Vivṛti* Passage Given Below

The annotations begin in manuscript J11 towards the end of Utpaladeva's detailed explanation of ĪPK 1.8.10, which runs thus:

> Therefore if there were no unity of cognitions, ordinary human practice could not occur. This unity comes from the unity of [conscious] manifestation (*prakāśa*); [and] it is [now] established that this [unity of conscious manifestation] is the single knowing subject.[24]

This verse and the following provide a conclusion for the lengthy Section on Knowledge (*Jñānādhikāra*), and they can be considered as a summary of the main thesis defended throughout its eight chapters.[25] The first part of this main thesis, presented here in a very condensed form, is the claim that contrary to what the Buddhists contend, consciousness is not a series of momentary cognitions that remain irreducibly distinct from each other, because the whole sphere of ordinary human practice (*lokapaddhati*/*vyavahāra*) rests on our capacity to synthesize our various cognitions, and this ability would remain inexplicable if we did not assume that these cognitions have a unity insofar as they are all limited aspects of a single enduring consciousness. In the course of this demonstration, Utpaladeva has endeavoured to show that defending in this way the existence of an enduring subjective reality or Self (*ātman*) is only possible provided that one accepts a form of absolute idealism: according to him, the whole universe is in fact nothing but a single, omnipotent consciousness out of which nothing exists and which playfully creates the world by merely manifesting itself in infinitely variegated forms, in a way somewhat similar to that of a dreamer perceiving things and persons that are in fact mere internal aspects taken on by his or her consciousness.[26] So the limited knowing subjects who are encountered in the *vyavahāra*, as well as their objects of knowledge, are nothing but limited manifestations of the single, all-encompassing reality constituted by the universal consciousness. This does not mean, however, that the countless differences appearing in the empirical world—including the ones between limited subjects and limited objects—should be discarded as pure illusions: according to the Śaiva nondualists, these differences are real precisely insamuch as they are ultimately aspects or manifestations of reality, namely the universal consciousness. The *Vivṛti* fragment presented below points out that these differences are not contradictory with the unity of ultimate reality, since the ontological status of differentiated phenomena is comparable to that of reflections (*pratibimba*) that

[24] ĪPK 1.8.10: *tad aikyena vinā na syāt saṃvidāṃ lokapaddhatiḥ | prakāśaikyāt tad ekatvaṃ mātaikaḥ sa iti sthitam* || Cf. Utpaladeva's *Vṛtti* on ĪPK 1.8.10, p. 40: *tattadvibhinnasaṃvidanusandhānena hi vyavahāraḥ. ekaś ca prakāśātmā tadanusandhānarūpaḥ sa eva caikaḥ pramātā paramātmasañjñaḥ*. "To explain: ordinary human practice [occurs] thanks to the synthesis of the various, distinct cognitions; and there is a single [entity] that consists in [conscious] manifestation and takes the form of the synthesis of these [various cognitions]; and this [entity] is precisely the single knowing subject who is called the Highest Self." All the translations of the *Vṛtti* given here are greatly indebted to Torella (2002).

[25] On the metaphysical tenets defended in the *Jñānādhikāra*, see in particular Torella (2002, pp. 85–152) and Ratié (2011a).

[26] On Utpaladeva's idealism (and on the limits of the dream analogy according to the Śaiva nondualists themselves) see e.g. Ratié (2010, 2011b).

are real *qua* manifestations but do not exist apart from the surface of the mirror reflecting them: the various phenomena constituting the empirical universe do exist insofar as they are manifest, but they have no independent existence over and above the entity (i.e. the universal consciousness) that manifests them by taking on their form, and ultimately they are nothing but expressions of this single manifesting entity. In other words, in itself, the differentiated manifestation of the universe is not an error (*bhrānti*); the error merely consists in not realizing that the differentiated phenomena only exist as reflections within consciousness. Yet Utpaladeva points out in the fragment that this does not amount to denying that errors can occur in the empirical world: mistaking for instance a piece of mother-of-pearl for silver is indeed an error, but it can only be said to be so with respect to the māyic subject (*māyāpramātṛ*), that is to say, with respect to the subject deluded into believing that phenomenal differences do exist outside of consciousness.

However fragmentary, the *Vivṛti* on verse 1.8.10 given below is an interesting discovery because modern historians tend to ascribe to Abhinavagupta (rather than Utpaladeva) this analogy between phenomena and reflections (*pratibimba*), or at least they often credit Abhinavagupta with being the first Śaiva author to make a full metaphysical use of it so as to explain the problematic ontological status of differentiated phenomena in a nondualistic perspective.[27] However, there is at least one brief allusion to this analogy in Utpaladeva's *Vṛtti*,[28] and most of all, Utpaladeva himself points out in his commentary on Somānanda's *Śivadṛṣṭi* that he has made use of this analogy at length in the *Vivṛti*:

> And [it is] that which consists in consciousness [that] takes the form of the universe, because objective entities exist while having as their reality nothing but a limpid consciousness, just as reflections [only exist] while having the mirror as their ultimate reality; and [I] have shown all this in detail in [my] *Ṭīkā* on the *Īśvarapratyabhijñā* [treatise].[29]

In the fragment edited here, the analogy is rather tersely put because Utpaladeva, who is providing a conclusion for the whole *Jñānādhikāra*, is simply summing up what he has already explained in greater detail in the preceding chapters; yet the fragment is enough to confirm that Utpaladeva himself had already placed this analogy between phenomena and reflections at the heart of Śaiva nondual ontology.

The *Vivṛti* on the next verse appears to be preserved in its entirety in the margins of manuscript J11, as can be seen from a comparison with Abhinavagupta's

[27] See e.g. Lawrence (2005), which is entirely devoted to "Abhinavagupta's use of the analogy of reflection" and concedes that Utpaladeva makes use of this analogy (p. 586), but immediately adds that "nevertheless, Utpaladeva does not thematize reflection as a basic theoretical and practical approach to the Ultimate Reality" while "it is Abhinavagupta who may be credited with making the metaphor of reflection into a favored trope of monistic Śaiva theological discourse." Note that Rastogi (1984, p. 28), acknowledges that Abhinavagupta "follows […] Utpala in using this analogy but with added dimensions"; he does not specify, however, the nature of these "added dimensions".

[28] See *Vṛtti* on ĪPK 2.4.19, p. 60, where Utpaladeva explains that consciousness can be possessed of agency (which involves both being one and taking on various forms) "because there is no contradiction [between its unity] and its taking on various reflections" (*anekapratibimbadhāraṇenāvirodhāt*).

[29] ŚDV, p. 14: *viśvātmatvaṃ ca cinmayasya pratibimbānām iva darpaṇaparamārthatvena bhāvānāṃ svacchacinmātrasatattvatayāvasthānāt. etac ca sarvam īśvarapratyabhijñāṭīkāyāṃ nipuṇam ālocitam.*

commentary in the ĪPVV. According to ĪPK 1.8.11,[30] the single consciousness of which the whole universe is a manifestation is none other than the Great Lord (Maheśvara), i.e. the god Śiva possessed of infinite powers (*śakti*). Thus according to this new verse, the universal consciousness is not only one and all-encompassing, but also all-powerful, because the very essence of consciousness is not to passively reflect a reality independent of it, but to dynamically grasp itself *as being this or that*. For the Śaivas this dynamic act of realization (*vimarśa*) or freedom (*svātantrya*) is the core of all knowledge and action—indeed the core of all reality—and the whole cosmogonic process of emanation is nothing but the unfolding of this *vimarśa*. Here Utpaladeva has recourse to the well-known Śaiva distinction between three stages of reality—superior (*para*), both superior and inferior (*parāpara*) and inferior (*apara*)[31] corresponding to three distinct ways for the universal consciousness of apprehending itself.

In the first, pure (*śuddha*) stage, called the state of Śiva (*śivatā*), the universal consciousness grasps itself as a pure subjectivity (literally, as an "I-ness", *ahantā*, as opposed to objectivity or "this-ness", *idantā*); that is to say, it realizes its own nature by expressing it as a pure "I" (*aham*), and in that state all knowledge and action are nothing but this unitary self-realization through which consciousness grasps itself as a pure freedom to manifest itself. All the objects of the universe must already exist at this level (otherwise, as the *Vivṛti* points out, their appearance at later stages of the process of emanation would remain inexplicable) but only in a subjective form, as an integral part of consciousness' subjectivity.

At the next level, the universal consciousness is no longer a pure subjectivity in the sense that it apprehends the universe as an objective entity, while remaining fully aware that all objects are nothing but manifestations of itself. Here Utpaladeva's phenomenological description is reminiscent of the experience made by anybody imagining at will a given object: picturing up anything in particular is only possible provided that the imagining consciousness grasps the imagined entity as somehow *distinct* from itself (as "this" rather than "I"); yet the imagining subject remains fully aware that what is pictured up is *nothing but his or her own consciousness* taking on that particular appearance. When the universal consciousness is aware of the entire phenomenal world in such a way, that is, when its self-realization no longer takes the sole form "I", but is rather expressed as "I am this" (*aham idam*), it experiences the so-called "state of Īśvara". The latter is both pure and impure (*śuddhāśuddha*) because on the one hand, consciousness remains fully aware that its subjectivity constitutes the whole of reality, including that of objects; on the other hand, it already involves a form of differentiation between "I" and "this" that somehow alters the absolute unity of consciousness: although consciousness then identifies both aspects of manifestation as one and the same reality, this very movement of identification involves as a prerequisite a minimal distinction between the two elements that are to be identified, and this, as Utpaladeva puts it, is "the cause of impurity", although it is not by itself impure.

[30] The verse is given below with the commentary.

[31] These states should not be confused with principles that may bear similar names within another Śaiva system of categorization, namely the scale of *tattva*s (thus the intermediary state of Īśvara is more than the mere *tattva* of Īśvara: see below, fn. 89).

Finally, when consciousness somehow loses the awareness of subjectivity and apprehends itself as if it were a world of objects cut off from subjectivity, as a mere "this", it reaches an impure (*śuddha*) state, that of the transmigrating individual who sees him- or herself as a spatially and temporally limited subject faced with objects endowed with an independent existence. In that state, the powers of knowledge and action appear to be restricted to a tiny fraction of reality—namely a particular human being—and utterly distinct from each other. In fact, however, even this impure state can only take place if the universal consciousness somehow remains aware of its infinite powers of knowlege and action and of their profound unity: the three stages are not understood as a chronological process in which each successive state would replace or cancel the previous one, but rather, as atemporal ways for consciousness to apprehend itself, the intermediary and impure levels arising on the background (*bhitti*) of the pure level without which they could not take place.[32] Utpaladeva strongly emphasizes this point in the *Vivṛti* while explaining the *Vṛtti*: [33] in his detailed commentary he insists that in all three states, the whole of reality amounts to nothing but the I-realization through which the universal consciousness freely chooses to apprehend itself in these different forms.

The *Vivṛti* passage edited and translated below is designed as a conclusion for the whole *Jñānādhikāra*, and it nicely sums up its metaphysical gist by reminding Utpaladeva's readers that according to the Śaiva nondualists, reality is nothing but a single, all-powerful and all-encompassing consciousness freely manifesting and apprehending itself in infinitely varied ways. Yet this conclusion is not quite representative of the *Jñānādhikāra* in the sense that it heavily relies on ideas (primarily the threefold typology of conscious states) that, in Abhinavagupta's own words, are "scripturally established"

[32] Cf. e.g. ĪPV, vol. I, pp. 192–193 (as edited in Ratié 2011b pp. 481–482), explaining ĪPK 1.5.10 (quoted below, fn. 78): *bahīrūpatayāpy ābhāsane'ntārūpatā na truṭyati, pramātraikātmyam āntaryam iti hi vakṣyate, tac ca sadaiva, prakāśasya pramāṭṛtvāt, tadātmatayā ca vināprakāśamānasyāvastutvāt. kintu tatrāham ity ucite parāmarśe yo'yam idantāparāmarśaḥ saiva bāhyatā, tataś cāntaḥsthitatvam aham ity etāvatā citsamucitenaiva vapuṣā parāmarśanam, tac ceha nīlādīnām asty eva, na tu nāstīti.* "The existence [of everything] in an internal form remains intact, even when [things] are manifested in an external form; for [Utpaladeva] will explain [later in the treatise] that existing internally is nothing but the identity with the knowing subject. And this [identity of everything with the knowing subject occurs] absolutely always, because [conscious] manifestation *is* the knowing subject, and because without this identity with the [conscious manifestation, any object] would be devoid of reality since it could not be manifest. Rather, the realization as 'this' [which occurs] whereas [in fact only] the realization 'I' is appropriate with respect to that [reality] is precisely [what is called] 'external existence', and therefore 'internal existence' is the realization [that occurs] in the only form appropriate for consciousness, [that is to say,] only thus: 'I'; and in this [system of ours, as stated by Utpaladeva in verse 1.5.10] 'there must be' such a [realization as 'I' even] for [objects] such as the blue, etc.—i.e., it is not [possible for this realization] not to occur."

[33] The *Vṛtti* on ĪPK 1.8.11 runs thus (pp. 40–41): *sa paramātmā cidrūpo vimarśākhyenaiva mukhyasvabhāvenāvyabhicāriṇā maheśvaraḥ. cittattvasya viśvātmanaḥ śivasañjñasyāhaṃvimarśanam eva śuddhe jñānakriye, bhinnābhinnajñeyakāryagate tv īśvarasya śuddhāśuddhe, bhinnārthaviṣaye tu puṃsaḥ sattvarajovṛttirūpe prakāśapravṛttisañjñe tamasā sañkucite'śuddha eva*. "The Great Lord is this Highest Self consisting in consciousness with his invariable fundamental nature, which is precisely what is called 'realization'. Pure knowledge and action are nothing but the realization [in the form] 'I' of the reality of consciousness called Śiva that is the essence of the universe; whereas [the knowledge and action] which regard objects of knowledge and action [characterized as] both differentiated and undifferentiated, and which are both pure and impure, [are nothing but the I-realization] of Īśvara; and [the knowledge and action] which regard differentiated objects, which consist in transformations of *sattva* and *rajas*, which are called [conscious] manifestation and activity, are contracted by *tamas* [and] are only impure, [are nothing but the I-realization] of the individual."

(*āgamasiddha*),[34] whereas this first and lengthiest part of the treatise is actually a highly polemical text that discusses logical, epistemological and metaphysical issues while conspicuously refraining from appealing to scriptural authority. This, however, is in accordance with Utpaladeva's overall strategy in the treatise, which consists in first demonstrating through mere experience and inference the validity of ideas that are showed *a posteriori* to be in accordance with the Śaiva scriptures.[35]

## Utpaladeva's *Vivṛti* on the End of Chapter 1.8: Text[36]

[37]*prakāśate tata eva sad iti katham etat syād*[38] *arthatālakṣaṇabhrānti.* ***grāhya-*** *grāhakābhāsamayo'yam*[39] *ekaḥ* ***prakāśātmā*** *prathamāno*[40] *na virudhyate* ***tayoḥ*** *pratibimbakalpatvenānatiriktatvāt*[41] ***tathā ca*** *sattvāt.* ***māyā****pramātrapekṣayā tu bhrāntir* ***yā kācid*** *rajatādiviṣayā sāpi visaṃvādavaśād uktā vakṣyate cāgre.*[42] *vimarśarahitasya prakāśasy****oktanyāyād*** *ayogāt pratyavamarśātmatayā sa evāntaḥ-prakāśa īśvara ity āha* ‖

**[ĪPK 1.8.11]** ***sa eva***[43] ***vimṛśattvena niyatena maheśvaraḥ | vimarśa eva devasya śuddhe jñānakriye yataḥ*** ‖ ‖

[44]*cetanaṃ cit prakāśanaṃ prakāśa iti* ***prakṛtipratyayābhyām*** *abhivyakto jñānak-riyāmayo vimarśalakṣaṇaḥ pūrvapratipāditanyāyena prathanasvabhāvo'* ***nusandhānātmanaḥ*** *paramātmano yas tad eva* ***tasya***[45] *māheśvaryam, tad āha sa paramātmeti.* ***jñānam ity api*** *bodhaḥ kriyā c****ocyate****, kevalaṃ bodhaḥ*[46] ***prādhānye-nā****tra khyāti, kriyety* ***api cākṣipta****bodhaṃ svātantryaṃ prādhyānyenocyate,* ***anavabodhasya***[47] *khyātīty asvātantryalakṣaṇatākṣepaḥ.*[48]

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[34] See below, fn. 89.

[35] On this strategy see Torella (2002, p. 30). On the complex relationship between reason and scripture in the Pratyabhijñā treatise see Torella (2013) and Ratié (2013).

[36] The text given here is written in J11 on the left and bottom margins of folio 202A, then on the left and bottom margins of 202B, and it ends on the top margin of 203A. For Abhinavagupta's commentary thereon see ĪPVV, vol. II, pp. 434–439. I could not find this quotation in the following ĪPV manuscripts that are known to contain other *Vivṛti* fragments: D2, $J^R$ (where the corresponding part of the ĪPV is not preserved), S2, S3, S5, S7, S9 and SOAS. I took the liberty of standardizing the spellings (*tattva* for *tatva*, etc.) and *sandhi* use.

[37] The beginning of the sentence seems to be lacking; see below, fn. 62.

[38] *katham etat syād* conj.: *kathā . . . . d* J11.

[39] ***grāhya****grāhakābhāsamayo'yam* conj. : ***grāhya****grāhakabhāsamayaṃyam* J11.

[40] ***prakāśātmā*** *prathamāno* conj. : *prakāśāṅgaprathamāno* J11.

[41] *pratibimbakalpatvenānatiriktatvāt* conj. : *pratibimbakalpatvenātiriktatvāt* J11.

[42] The text of the marginal annotation is followed by ‖ 87 ‖ (i.e. the number corresponding to ĪPK 1.8.10 if one counts the verses continuously from the beginning of the treatise).

[43] *sa eva* ĪPK: *sa eve* J11.

[44] Between the verse and the beginning of the *Vivṛti*, the marginal annotation quotes the *Vṛtti* in full.

[45] I assume that the corresponding *pratīka* given in ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 435 (***asyeti*** *paramātmanaḥ*) is a corruption for *tasya*.

[46] *bodhaḥ kriyā c****ocyate****, kevalaṃ bodhaḥ* conj. : *bodhaḥ kriyā . . . . te kevalaṃ bodhaḥ* || J11.

[47] ***anavabodhasya*** conj. : ***avabodhasya*** J11. Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 436: *ākṣepahetum āh****ānavabodhyasy****eti.*

[48] *asvātantryalakṣaṇatākṣepaḥ* conj.: *asvātantrya . . . . kṣepaḥ* J11.

***vastv ekam evā**tra bodhasvātantryāvibhāgenāvasthitam ubhayadharmatvenāpy upadiśyamānam anyonyaviraheṇānayor utthānābhāvāt svātantryam eva vimarśaśabdasy**āñjasyenā**bhidheyaṃ maheśvaratvam, tad āha vimarśākhyenety avyabhicāriṇeti ca. **bodhasyāvyabhicaraṇīyo'pi**[49] **vimarśaḥ sadāvyabhicāravattvāt.**[50] **tadāpy** avyabhicārīti yujyate vaktuṃ tad vimarśanaṃ bodhasya mukhyasvabhāvabhūtam*[51] aham ity evaṃrūpaṃ svabhāvatvāt, svātantryasya ca tan mukhyaṃ jñānakriyātmatvaṃ śivatā ca tad āha cittattvasyeti.*

***tadā ce**dantāvabhāsanīyabhāvāḥ sthitā*[52] *evāntar ahantāsvātantryāsvādanihnutāḥ, anyathā tathecchayā nonmiṣeyuḥ. **iṣyamāṇābhāve** nirviṣayecchaiva*[53] *na syāt tasyā api pūrvecchāntaranirmite viṣaye'navasthāprasaṅgaḥ. **evaṃ cā**vasthānam anapāyopajanam ata eva śuddhatayoktam.*

***saivā**hantā yadedantāvacchinnatattvabhuvanāvabhāsamayy aham idaṃ prathate tadedantāvicchedavikārāvabhāse'py atrābhraṣṭāhantāsvātantryecchādinaikyamayatvāt*[54] *pūrvavat svabhāvātirodhānāc **chuddhatve'pi** dvaitamayamāyāvimohaviṣayoparacanād **aśuddhihetutvād** īśvaradaśāyām apy aśuddhis tad āha bhinnābhinneti. na tu svayam aśuddhatā na hy ekatra viruddhāśuddhiśuddhidharmādhyāsaḥ.*[55]
***saiva** punar ahantā māyāśaktivaśāt sarvam evedantāvimarśatirohitatattvabhuvanādyavabhāsabhāgavyāpyavasthānā*[56] *yadā tadā saṃsāripuruṣadaśā tad āha bhinnārtheti. tasyāṃ ca daśāyāṃ tad ahaṃvimarśanam*[57] ***aham ayam** idaṃ ghaṭādi jānāmi **karomi ce**ti **vaiyadhikaraṇyena** bhinnagrāhyāpekṣabhinnagrāhakamātrabhāgāvagāhiprakāśarūpaṃ kriyārūpañ ca bhinnedaṃbhāgāvasthitabuddhyādiśarīratayotpatteḥ*[58] *pracyutasvarūpaṃ*

[49] ***bodhasyāvyabhicaraṇīyo'pi*** conj. : *bodhasyāvyabhicāreṇa yo'pi* J11. Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 436, quoted below, fn. 76.

[50] ***sadāvyabhicāravattvāt*** conj. : *sarvāvyabhicāravatvā* J11. Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 436, quoted below, fn. 76.

[51] *mukhyasvabhāvabhūtam* conj. : *mukhyasvabhāvaṃ bhūtam* J11.

[52] ***tadā ce**dantāvabhāsanīyabhāvāḥ sthitā* conj. : ***tadā ce**dantāvabhāsanīyābhāvaḥ sthita* J11. The conjecture seems to be required by the rest of the sentence as well as Abhinavagupta's summary of the passage. Thus the fragment as preserved in the margin of J11 can only mean that *there can be no objects* in any form in the state of consciousness described here, whereas according to ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 437, Utpaladeva's intention here is precisely to show that there must be a realization of objective entities even in that state: *nanv ātmamātravimarśo'sāv aham iti tatra bhāvanirbharatā na vimṛṣṭaiva. naivam ity āha **tadā ce**ti*. "[–Objection:] 'But within this realization of the pure Self [in the form] 'I', the fact that [consciousness] contains the [various] objective entities (*bhāva*) is not realized at all.' [Utpaladeva] answers that it is not the case with [the sentence beginning with] *tadā ca*…"

[53] *nirviṣayecchaiva* conj.: *niviṣayecchaiva* J11.

[54] *atrābhraṣṭāhantāsvātantryecchādinaikyamayatvāt* conj. : *atra bhraṣṭāhantāsvātantryācchādinaikyamayatvāt* J11.

[55] *ekatra viruddhāśuddhiśuddhidharmādhyāsaḥ* conj.: *ekatra viruddhā . . śuddhidharmādhyāsaḥ* J11.

[56] From °*dyavabhāsabhāgavyāpyavasthānā* onwards the quotation is given on the top margin of folio 203A.

[57] *tad ahaṃvimarśanam* conj. : *tadāhaṃvimarśanam* J11. Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 437: *tasyāṃ daśāyām ahaṃvimarśanaṃ yat tad aśuddham uktam iti dūreṇa sambandhaḥ.*

[58] *kriyārūpañ ca bhinnedaṃbhāgāvasthitabuddhyādiśarīratayotpatteḥ* conj.: *kriyā || pañcābhinnedaṃ bhāgāvasthitabuddhyādiśarīratāyotpatteḥ* J11. These conjectures are based on Abhinavagupta's commentary (see below, fn. 83): Abhinavagupta was obviously commenting on a text that had *kriyārūpañ ca* rather than just *kriyā*, and his analysis of the compound ending in °*śarīratayā* shows that *bhinna*° was not preceded by *pañcā*° in the text that he was reading.

*sattvarajovyapadeśaṃ deśakālāvacchede niyamād antarnītatamaḥsaṃparkam īśvarāpratyabhijñānamayapuruṣasambandhijñānakriyāsvabhāvam*[59] *uktam.*

*sarvaṃ cātrāvasthātraye'py ahaṃvimarśanam eva śuddhāśuddhajñānakriyāvidhānāy* ***ānūditaṃ*** *sarvatrāsya śuddhasya jñānakriyāsvabhāvasya,*[60] ***etā eva ca***[61] *parādidaśā* ***vakṣyanta*** *iti. iti jñānādhikāraḥ.*

## Utpaladeva's *Vivṛti* on the End of Chapter 1.8: Translation

<And that which>[62] is manifest exists for the very reason [that it is manifest], so how could that involve any error consisting in [appearing] in the form of objects?[63]

[59] °*svabhāvam* conj. : °*sambandham* J11. Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 438, quoted below, fn. 87 (*tatsambandhinyau ye jñānakriye, tatsvabhāvaṃ tad ahaṃvimarśanam…*).

[60] *sarvatrāsya śuddhasya jñānakriyāsvabhāvasya khyāpanāya* conj. : *sarvatrāsya śuddhajñānakriyāsvabhāvasya khyāpanāya* J11. I have many doubts regarding this conjecture, and there are certainly other ways to understand the passage; unfortunately Abhinavagupta's commentary is not of much help here, and the other interpretations I can come up with seem less satisfactory than this one.

[61] ***etā eva ca*** conj. : *etā evaṃ ca* J11. Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 439, quoted below, fn. 89. One could also surmise that it is the *pratīka* in the ĪPVV that is corrupted (in J11, the corresponding passage of the ĪPVV bears *etāṃ eva ceti*, which might be the result of a failed attempt to correct *etā eva ceti* into *etā evaṃ ceti* in accordance with the text of the *Vivṛti* given in the margin). However, if Utpaladeva had meant that these states are to be explained "thus" (*evam*)—i.e. as forms of the I-realization—later in the treatise, I assume that he would have rather said *etāś ca parādidaśā evaṃ vakṣyante*, or *evañ caitāḥ parādidaśā vakṣyante.*

[62] The beginning of the first sentence preserved in the fragment seems to be lacking and it is tempting to consider that the words ***yac ca***, quoted by Abhinavagupta (ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 434) just before he turns to the explanation of the present sentence, originally came immediately before the first words of the fragment. I have translated the passage accordingly.

[63] The beginning of the passage is corrupted (see above, fn. 37 and 62) and my interpretation of it is merely tentative. It is based on Abhinavagupta's commentary, according to which Utpaladeva's interlocutor has just argued that if reality and manifestation are to be equated, then even the differences pertaining to objective phenomena must be real, and as a result the cognitions regarding them cannot have a real unity. See ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 434: *nanu māyāśaktyā yo bhedo'vabhāsitaḥ, sa kiṃ na bhedaḥ, tataś ca saṃvedyātmanāṃ saṃvidām ity ayuktoktiḥ.* "[–Objection:] But how could the difference manifested [among objects of knowledge] by the power of *māyā* not be a difference[, since it is manifest]? And therefore [Utpaladeva] has wrongly stated that [there is a unity] 'of cognitions that have as their essence the objects of knowledge'." From Abhinavagupta's explanations (ibid.), it appears that the gist of Utpaladeva's immediate answer (which is not preserved in J11) consisted in maintaining that "although cognitions have as their essence the objects of knowledge, [they do have] a unity" (*saṃvedyātmanāṃ ceti yadi, tathāpy advayam*) while insisting that for all that, manifestations of differentiated objects are not to be discarded as pure illusions (*tarhi bhrāntā nīlādayaḥ syuḥ. atrāpy āha* ***nāpīti.*** "[–The objector: 'But] then [objects] such as the blue and so on must [all] be erroneous.' To this [objection] too, [Utpaladeva] replies by saying: 'Nor is it the case that…'."). In other words, Utpaladeva is presenting here one of the most original aspects of his Śaiva nondualistic ontology: on the one hand, the differences of the phenomenal universe are not illusory because they are manifest, and for that very reason they partake of the only reality, i.e. conscious manifestation (*prakāśa*); on the other hand, ultimately only nonduality (*advaya*) is real, because differentiated phenomena only exist as limited, internal aspects of the single, nondual consciousness. So the differentiated phenomenal world is not an error (*bhrānti*) inasmuch as there is no contradiction (cf. the verb *virudhyate* in the next sentence) between the ultimate reality and the differentiated objects and subjects, since the latter are mere aspects that consciousness takes on without ceasing to be consciousness (whereas error involves such a contradiction, *virodha*: a piece of mother-of-pearl cannot become silver without ceasing to be mother-of-pearl, so that the two natures are contradictory, which is why apprehending mother-of-pearl as if it were silver is a mistake that

This single[, ultimately real][64] Self [consisting in] manifestation (*prakāśātman*) does not become contradictory [due to its] being manifest while having [both] the aspects of the [limited] apprehending subject and the apprehended object, because these two, [namely the apprehending subject and the apprehended object,] are nothing over and above [the Self manifesting them,] since they are similar to [mere] reflections [that do not exist over and above the mirror reflecting them],[65] and since [they only] exist thus, [i.e. only as being similar to reflections in a mirror].[66] Nonetheless, with respect to the māyic knowing subject, whatever error [might occur] regarding e.g. silver [when we mistake mother-of-pearl for silver] has been said [earlier in the treatise] and will be said in the sequel[67] to be [an error] because of its unreliability (*visaṃvāda*).[68]

Footnote 63 continued
can be cancelled later by the realization "this is not silver but mother-of-pearl"). The key to the problematic ontological status of differentiated phenomena is the notion of reflection (*pratibimba*) to which Utpaladeva is about to have recourse, the main idea being that the unitary consciousness and the differentiated aspects that it takes on are no more contradictory than the undifferentiated background (*bhitti*) constituted by the surface of a mirror and the multifarious reflections that it shows by manifesting itself. On this idea that differentiated phenomena are not contradictory with the unity of consciousness and on the Śaivas' use of the notion of background to justify the principle that nonduality encompasses duality instead of extending it, see Ratié (2011, pp. 656–662) and Ratié (2013b).

[64] Cf. Abhinavagupta's gloss in ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 434 (see below, fn. 65).

[65] See ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 434: *nanv etat kathaṃ saṅgacchatāṃ nīlādayo bhinnā abhinnāś ceti. ittham ity āha* ***grāhy****eti. grāhako'tra māyīyaḥ śarīrādiḥ.* ***prakāśātme****ti paramārthapramātā.* ***tayor*** *iti grāhyagrāhakayoḥ. etac ca nirṇītaṃ tan mayā dṛśyata iti sūtre.* "But how could the blue and [other objects of knowledge] be both different and nondifferent? With [the words beginning with] *grāhya*°, [Utpaladeva] answers that [it is possible] in the [following] way. Here the 'apprehending subject' is the māyic [knowing subject, that is to say,] the body and [the other objective entities with which māyic subjects wrongly identify]. [The compound] *prakāśātman* [means] the real subject (*paramārthapramātṛ*) [as opposed to the māyic subject]. 'These two' are the apprehended subject and the apprehended object. And this has [already] been explained in the verse beginning with *tan mayā dṛśyate…*" The latter comment is an allusion to ĪPK 1.4.8: *tan mayā dṛśyate dṛṣṭo'yaṃ sa ity āmṛśaty api | grāhyagrāhakatābhinnāv arthau bhātaḥ pramātari ||* "Therefore even when one realizes [something in the form] '[this] is seen by me', '[this] was seen' [or just] 'this' [or] 'that', the two things [appearing in such thoughts,] although differentiated as being [respectively] the apprehending subject and the apprehended object, are [only] manifested within the [single] knowing subject." Cf. *Vṛtti ad loc.*, p. 18: *…sarvatraikapramātṛlīnāv evānubhāvyānubhāvakau māyākṛtavicchinnāvabhāsāv api prakāśete.* "In all [these cases,] both the experiencing subject and the experienced object, although they have separated manifestations produced by *māyā*, are only manifest insofar as they are immersed (*līna*) in the single knowing subject."

[66] Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 434: ***tathā ce****ti pratibimbakalpatayaiva.* "'And [since they exist] thus' [means]: only as being similar to reflections."

[67] According to Abhinavagupta's explanation (see below, fn. 68), here the *Vivṛti* alludes to Utpaladeva's previous examination of contradiction (*bādha*)—i.e., most probably the one conducted in ĪPK 1.7.6–13—and to his definition of the means of valid knowledge (*pramāṇa*), i.e. in all likelihood to the extensive discussions on this topic in chapter 2.3 (see in particular ĪPK 2.3.13 on the notion of *visaṃvāda*/*asaṃvāda*).

[68] Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 434: *nanv evaṃ śuktikārajatam api pratibimbakalpam ity utsannās tribhuvane bhrāntivṛttāntāḥ, satyaṃ paraprakāśāpekṣayā, tarhi kva bhrāntivyavahāraḥ. āha* ***māye****ti.* ***yā kācid*** *iti sarvā lokaprasiddhā bhrāntiḥ satyam uktā bādhacintāyāṃ vakṣyate ca pramāṇalakṣaṇe, kintu māyāpramātāram apekṣya yatas tasyaivārthakriyāviṣayau saṃvādavisaṃvādau sambhavataḥ.* "[–Objection:] 'But [if all phenomena are] thus [similar to mere reflections in the mirror of consciousness instead of having an independent existence outside of consciousness, then] since the silver [for which we mistake] mother-of-pearl is also similar to a reflection [inasmuch as it does not exist outside of the

[And] because, according to a principle stated [earlier], there can be no [conscious] manifestation (*prakāśa*) devoid of a realization (*vimarśa*),[69] this internal manifestation is none other than the Lord, since it has a realization (*pratyavamarśa*) as its essence. This is [what the following verse] explains:

**[ĪPK 1.8.11] And this [single knowing subject] is none other than the Great Lord insofar as he is constantly engaged in an act of realization; since pure knowledge and action are nothing but the Lord's realization.**

The Highest Self whose essence is synthesis[70] [is none other than the Great Lord:] his sovereignty[, or his being the Great Lord (*māheśvarya*),] is precisely his nature of manifesting itself (*prathana*), [a nature] which consists [both] in knowledge and action, which is characterized as a realization (*vimarśa*), [and] which is made clear by the grammatical basis and affix (*prakṛtipratyaya*) in [the words] "sentience" (*cetana*), "consciousness" (*cit*), "manifesting" (*prakāśana*) or "[conscious] manifestation" (*prakāśa*), according to the principle previously explained.[71] This is what

Footnote 68 continued
cognition grasping it], all talks about error should be abolished in the three worlds! [This is] true with respect to the highest [conscious] manifestation (*paraprakāsa*), so what could [our] ordinary speeches and activities (*vyavahāra*) regarding error [really] be about?' [Utpaladeva] replies [to this objection by saying] 'with respect to the] māyic [knowing subject]'. 'Whatever [error' means] any error that is well known in the world; [Utpaladeva] has already said that it is rightly [called an error] in the course of examining contradiction, and [error] will also be explained while defining the means of valid knowledge, but [only] with respect to the māyic knowing subject, since it is only for this [māyic knowing subject] that the reliability or unreliability (*saṃvādavisaṃvāda*) [of a cognition] can occur with respect to efficacy (*arthakriyā*)." In other words, the Śaiva nondualists maintain that the distinction between the validity and invalidity of cognitions—which, according to the Buddhist epistemologists, depends on the cognitions' reliability or lack thereof, i.e. on the ability or inability of a given cognition to bring about an expected result—is not absurd, even though ultimately all cognitions involving the awareness of a limited object and subject are inadequate; but such a distinction only makes sense in the sphere of ordinary human practice, for a māyic subject, that is, for a subject deluded into thinking that (s)he is not the all-encompassing and all-powerful universal consciousness.

[69] As noted by Abhinavagupta, this is an allusion to ĪPK 1.5.11 (see ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 435: ***uktanyāyād*** *iti svabhāvam avabhāsasyety atrāntare*), which runs thus: *svabhāvam avabhāsasya vimarśaṃ vidur anyathā | prakāśo'rthoparakto'pi sphaṭikādijaḍopamaḥ* || "[The wise] know that the nature of manifestation is realization (*vimarśa*); otherwise the [conscious] manifestation (*prakāśa*), although coloured by objects, would be similar to an inert [reflecting object] such as a crystal, etc." In other words, any conscious manifestation (including perception) involves an act of realization through which consciousness, instead of passively reflecting a given, dynamically grasps itself as having this or that form. On this famous verse and its commentaries see e.g. Alper (1987), Torella (2002, p. 118, Ratié (2007, fn. 59, pp. 339–340, Ratié (2010, pp. 465–468) and Ratié (2011, pp. 495–525).

[70] Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 435: ***anusandhānātmana*** *iti pramāsu svātantryaṃ darśitam.* "[The Highest Lord] 'whose essence is synthesis'—[His] freedom with respect to cognitions has [already] been shown." Abhinavagupta's elliptic comment hints at the first chapters of the treatise (1.2 to 1.4) where Utpaladeva criticizes the Buddhist view of consciousness as a series of momentary and irreducibly heterogeneous cognitive events and shows that memory for example can only be explained if cognitions are only partial manifestations of an enduring consciousness that is free to separate and unite its own various aspects; and according to Utpaladeva, this lasting awareness capable of synthesizing cognitions is none other than the Self.

[71] This is most probably an allusion to ĪPK 1.5.12 and Utpaladeva's lost commentary thereon in the *Vivṛti.* Thus after explaining in ĪPK 1.5.11 (see above, fn. 69) that *vimarśa* is the core of any conscious reality, Utpaladeva adds in ĪPK 1.5.12: *ātmāta eva caitanyaṃ citkriyācitikartṛtā- | tātparyeṇoditas tena*

[the *Vṛtti*] says with "this Highest Self."[72] Even in [the word] "knowledge" (*jñāna*) [when taken on its own, what is] expressed is [both] consciousness and action;[73] only in that [word "knowledge", it is] consciousness [that] predominantly manifests itself; and even in [the word] "action", [what] is predominantly expressed is a freedom (*svātantrya*) in which consciousness is implied (*ākṣipta*), because in [the action

Footnote 71 continued
jaḍāt sa hi vilakṣaṇaḥ ‖ "It is for this reason that the Self is called 'sentience' (*caitanya*), which primarily means the action (*kriyā*) that is consciousness, [i.e.] the agency (*kartṛtā*) of consciousness; for this is what differentiates this [Self] from the insentient." In other words, according to Utpaladeva, the abstract affix in the word *caitanya*, although traditionally explained as expressing a state (*bhāva*), primarily conveys the agency of consciousness. See *Vṛtti*, p. 12: *ātmadravyasya bhāvātmakam apy etaj jaḍād bhedakatayā vimarśākhyaṃ mukhyaṃ rūpam uktaṃ caitanyaṃ dṛśiśaktiś citir iti. sā cetanakriyā citikartṛtaiva.* "'Sentience' is said to be the fundamental nature, called *vimarśa*, of the substance that is the Self, although it consists in a state (*bhāva*), insofar as it distinguishes [the Self] from the insentient: [the word denotes] the action of becoming conscious (*citi*), the power of perceiving (*dṛśiśakti*); it is the activity of consciousness, which is nothing but the agency of consciousness." On the reason why in this case an affix expressing a state (*bhāva*) in fact conveys agency (*kartṛtā*) according to Abhinavagupta, see Torella (2002, fn. 25, pp. 119–120): the abstract formed from *cetana* denotes a relation (*sambandha*), and through this relation, the two relata, namely the *agent* and *action* of consciousness. See also ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 435, where an opponent wonders how the affix in a word like *prakāśa* can convey the idea of an active realization: *syād etat: bhavatu nāma prakṛtau saṃvedanalakṣaṇaḥ prakāśaḥ, pratyaye tu kvipi bhāva evābhidheyo, na tu vimarśaḥ, tat katham uktaṃ* ***prakṛtipratyayābhyām*** *iti. evaṃ manyate dhātunā tāvat saṃvedanaṃ jñānalakṣaṇam uktaṃ ghañādayas tu kriyāyām eva vidhīyante, sā tu kriyā dharmāntareṇa siddhatākhyena bheditaiva bhāvapratyayavācyā siddhatāpratyavamarśayogyataivāyaṃ pākaḥ iti.* "This might be [objected by an opponent:] 'Fine, let [us] admit that in the grammatical basis [of the word *prakāśa* is expressed the fact that] *prakāśa* consists in consciousness; nonetheless, in the *kvip* affix [occurring in this word,] only a state (*bhāva*) is expressed, and not an [act of] realization (*vimarśa*). So how can [Utpaladeva] claim that [the nature of consciousness which is characterized as a realization is made clear] 'by the grammatical basis and affix'?' [–Answer: Utpaladeva] understands [this] in the following way. To begin with, [in such a word,] consciousness, which consists in knowledge, is expressed by the root (*dhātu*); but [affixes] such as the *ghañ* affix [usually understood as expressing a state (*bhāva*)] are indeed used with respect to action; only this action can be expressed by the affix [conveying] a state provided that it is distinguished by another property called 'being accomplished', [i.e.] it can be the object of the realization that it is accomplished, as in 'this cooking' (*pāka*)." In the latter case though, the realization that the action is accomplished does not depend on the very nature of the action of cooking, but rather, on the realizing subject who happens to be different from the action, whereas in the case of consciousness, this process "rests on the freedom [of consciousness], which has as its nature a realization characterized as being accomplished" (*siddhatārūpapratyavamarśasvabhāve svātantrye viśrāmyati*, ibid.). That is, as far as I understand: in the case of consciousness, the action and the realization that it is accomplished are one and the same thing.

[72] That is to say, the *Vṛtti* conveys this very idea by explaining that the conscious manifestation (*prakāśa*) discussed in the previous verse is precisely the Highest Self (i.e., an agent endowed with powers rather than a mirror passively reflecting the universe).

[73] Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, pp. 435–436: *nanv evaṃ cid ity atra yadi jñānakriye praviṣṭe tarhi jñānam ity atrāpi prakṛtipratyayasadbhāvāt te praviṣṭa eva, tat kiṃ punaḥ kriyety adhikam abhidhīyate. atrocyate* ***jñānam ity apī****ti. satyam evam ekākiny apy atra śabda ity apiśabdaḥ.* ***ucyata*** *iti prakṛtipratyayabhāgadvayena.* "[–Objection:] But [if it is] so, if [both] knowledge and action are [already] contained within this [word], 'consciousness', then since they must be contained in the [word] 'knowledge' too due to the presence of the basis and affix, what more could be expressed with [the word] 'action' [when we say 'knowledge and action' rather than just 'knowledge']? [Utpaladeva] replies to this [objection by saying] 'even in [the word] knowledge…'. The word 'even' [means]: this is true thus even in the [case of this] word when it is on its own; [and knowledge and action are] 'expressed' through the two aspects that are the grammatical basis and the affix."

expressed by the verb when we say] '[X] manifests itself', the fact that the unconscious is characterized by a lack of freedom is implied.[74]

Within that [nature of the Highest Self] is a reality which is absolutely one, which exists as [something] that is not distinct from consciousness (*bodha*) and freedom (*svātantrya*), which is taught to possess both of these properties [—namely consciousness and freedom—] because these two cannot occur without each other, which is freedom itself, which is directly expressed by the word "realization" (*vimarśa*), [and] which is [nothing but] sovereignty (*maheśvaratva*).[75] This is [what the *Vṛtti*] says [when stating that the Great Lord's fundamental nature is precisely] "what is called 'realization'" (*vimarśākhya*) and that [this fundamental nature] is "invariable" (*avyabhicārin*), [i.e. literally it does not deviate (*vyabhicar-*) from consciousness]. Realization is also what consciousness can never deviate from, because [both consciousness and realization] possess [this property of] not deviating [from each other].[76] For this reason too (*tadāpi*),[77] the realization that is the fundamental form of consciousness and

[74] In the case of the word "action" (*kriyā*), the idea of consciousness is not directly conveyed, as emphasized in ĪPVV, vol. II, 436: *yatrāpi bodhabhāgābhidhāyakaṃ bhāgāntaraṃ nāsti, tatrāpy evam ity apiśabdaḥ. ata eva pūrvatr**ocyata** ity uktam, iha tv **ākṣipt**eti*. "It is so even in the [case of the word 'action',] where there is no other aspect directly expressing the aspect of consciousness—this is [what] the word 'even' [means here]; this is the reason why previously, [i.e. when talking about action as conveyed by the word 'knowledge', Utpaladeva] said that it 'is expressed' [by that word], whereas here [he only says that consciousness] is 'implied' [in the word 'action']." According to the *Vivṛti* as I understand it (but I might be wrong, and the text is corrupted here: see above, fn. 47 and 48), even the word "action" implies consciousness because the freedom (*svātantrya*) involved in the very notion of action can only belong to a conscious entity and not to some inert object.

[75] Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 436: *nanu vimarśaḥ kasmān māheśvaryam. āh**āñjasyene**ti. ananyāpekṣatā hi vimarśaḥ, saiva ca svatantratā.* "But how is it that realization is sovereignty [itself]? [Utpaladeva] answers [this question with the word] 'directly'; for realization is the fact of not depending on anything else; and that is nothing but freedom."

[76] The passage is not easy to understand and the text as it appears in the margins of J11 seems to be corrupted here (see above, fn. 49 and 50). I have corrected it according to Abhinavagupta's understanding and readings in ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 436: *nanu bodhasya vimarśo vyāpakaḥ svāmī, bodho hi vimarśaṃ na vyabhicarati na tyajati kadācit, tatas tasyāvyabhicaraṇe karmatāyāṃ vācyāyāṃ kathaṃ kartṛtoktety āśaṅkya samavyāptikayor itthaṃ abhidhāne'pi na doṣa iti brūte. **bodhasyāvyabhicaraṇīyo'pi vimarśaḥ sad**eti. bodhasya vimarśo'vyabhicaraṇīyaḥ, sa cāpi bodho'vyabhicaraṇīyaḥ sāmarthyād vimarśasya, tasmād asyāvyabhicāriṇo vimarśasyāpi kartṛtā na na yuktā. samavyāptikatve hetum āh**āvyabhicāravattvād** iti paraspareṇeti yāvat.* "'[– Objection:] But [it is] realization [that] is the controlling [agent] pervading consciousness; for consciousness does not deviate from realization, nor does it abandon it in any circumstance; therefore, since [we] must state that [consciousness] is the object on which the action [of realization is exerted,] given that this [consciousness] cannot deviate [from realization and is therefore a passive object rather than a free agent], how can [Utpaladeva] assert the agency [of consciousness]?' Having anticipated this [objection, Utpaladeva] explains that since thus both [consciousness and realization] are said to equally pervade [each other], there is no fault [here]. 'Realization is also what consciousness can never deviate from' [means that] realization is what consciousness cannot deviate from, but consciousness too is what realization, of necessity, cannot deviate from; therefore it is not [the case] that this [consciousness], which does not deviate from realization either, cannot be an agent. [Utpaladeva] states the reason why [consciousness and realization] equally pervade [each other] with [the words] 'because [both consciousness and realization] possess [this property of] not deviating'—the implied meaning is: from each other."

[77] Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 436: ***tadāpī**ty avyabhicāravattvaṃ yad uktaṃ tato'pi hetoḥ…* "[Here] *tadāpi* [means]: and also for the reason which is the fact [just] stated that [both consciousness and realization] possess [the property of] not deviating [from each other]…"

takes the form "I" can be said to be invariable because it is the [very] nature [of consciousness]; and this [realization] is the fundamental identity of freedom with [both] knowledge and action, and the state of Śiva (*śivatā*)—this [is what the *Vṛtti*] says with [the words] "reality of consciousness" (*cittattva*) [in the sentence: "pure knowledge and action are nothing but the realization in the form "I" of the reality of consciousness called Śiva that is the essence of the universe"].

And then, [i.e. when consciousness is in that state of Śiva,] objective entities (*bhāva*) that are liable to be manifested as this (*idantā*) must [already] exist within [consciousness, although in that state they are] concealed by the relish of [consciousness enjoying its own] freedom [expressed] as "I" (*ahantā*); otherwise[, if objective entities did not already exist in a subjective form in that state,] they could not appear thus out of [the Lord's] will [at later stages]: if there were no desired object (*iṣyamāṇa*), the very desire [to create], being devoid of object, could not take place; and if the object of this [desire to create] were created by some other, previous desire [to create, this previous desire would in turn be devoid of object, and] there would follow an infinite regress.[78] And this existence [of objective entities] can occur without difficulty thus, [i.e. in the subjective form "I"]—this is why [we] have described [the existence of objective entities] as being pure [in that state of consciousness].[79]

[78] Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 437: *nanv asanto'pīcchayonmiṣeyur ity āśaṅkyāh**eṣyamāṇe**ti. nabhavane hetur nirviṣayatvam eva. avaśyambhāvikarmaparigrahā kriyā tatkarmābhāve na bhavati jīvanam iva prāṇābhāve, tathā ceṣikriyā…* "[Utpaladeva] states [the passage beginning with] *iṣyamāṇa-* while anticipating this objection: 'But even though [objects] do not exist [in the state of Śiva], they may appear [at later stages] through [the Lord's] will.' The reason why [according to him, a desire to create objects] could not arise [at later stages if there were no objects in the state of Śiva] is the very fact that [the desire to create arising before the creation of objects] would [have to] be devoid of object; [but] action bears on an object (*karman*) that necessarily exists, and without that object it does not occur—for example, life [does not occur] in the absence of breath; and the same is true of the action of desiring." This passage of the *Vivṛti* sums up a reasoning already expounded at length in chapter 1.5. See ĪPK 1.5.10: *svāminaś cātmasaṃsthasya bhāvajātasya bhāsanam | asty eva na vinā tasmād icchāmarśaḥ pravartate ||* "And there must be a manifestation of all the [objective] entities [as] existing in the Lord's Self; [for] without this [manifestation], the realization [consisting in] a desire could not occur." For Utpaladeva's *Vṛtti* thereon see Torella (2002, p. 118); on Abhinavagupta's explanations see Ratié 2011, pp. 480-495. The gist of the argument is the following. Any desire to create involves a limitation of such a desire to the specific object that a creator wishes to bring about (otherwise the potter's realization "I want to make a pot" might as well be "I want to make a cloth"); but how can a creative desire be limited to a specific object whereas by definition that object does not exist yet at the time of the will to create? One could argue that it is possible because the potter who wants to make a pot for instance *imagines* the pot before he actually makes it; but the imaginary pot in turn is the result of a *creative act of imagination* that must be preceded by a will to create the imaginary object (e.g. "I want to picture up a pot"); and this creative will in turn must be restricted to a specific object—etc. The only way out of this infinite regress is to assume that all objects are already present within consciousness before consciousness manifests them, but only in a subjective form.

[79] Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 437: *nanv evaṃ bhāvābhāsān avasthitān apekṣamāṇo vimarśaḥ kathaṃ śuddhaḥ. ittham ity ucyata **evaṃ ce**ti. anena prakāreṇāham iti rūpeṇa yad bhāvānām avasthānaṃ tan nityaṃ paramātmano na bhinnaṃ tad eva cāham iti rūpam iti nāsyāśuddhiḥ kācit. na hi vyatiriktaṃ tadā kiñcid apekṣitavyam asti.* "But [if] thus [there is no infinite regress because objects already exist at that stage,] how could the realization [occurring then] be pure if it depends the phenomena of objective entities that [already] exist [in that state]? [Utpaladeva] explains that [it is possible] in the [following] way with [the sentence beginning with] *evaṃ ca*: the existence of objective entities [that occurs 'thus', i.e.] in this manner, in the form 'I', is never separated from the Highest Self, and it is nothing but the form 'I', so it involves no impurity whatsoever; for in that [state of consciousness] nothing is to be desired that would be separated [from the subject]."

When this same subjectivity (*ahantā*), being full of the manifestation of ontological principles and worlds that are separated [from it insofar as they appear] in an objective form (*idantā*), is manifest [in the form] "I am this", then [there is purity], because the nature [of consciousness] remains unconcealed as before, since even though this [state of Īśvara] involves the manifestation of an alteration [of reality] due to the separation of objectivity [that appears at that stage], it is [still] full of the unity with subjectivity, freedom, will and so on, which have not disappeared. [Yet] even though it is pure, even in this state of Īśvara there is impurity inasmuch as [this state], by drawing an outline of objects through the confusion of *māyā* that is full of duality, is the cause of impurity—this is [what the *Vṛtti*] says with [the words] "both differentiated and undifferentiated" (*bhinnābhinna*). But [this state] is not impure by itself (*svayam*); for [it is] not [possible] to ascribe to one [and the same entity] the properties of purity and impurity, which are contradictory.[80]

On the contrary, when, due to the power of *māyā*, the existence of the same subjectivity is pervaded by the aspects of manifestation [consisting of] the ontological principles, worlds and so on [while being] entirely concealed by a realization that takes an objective form (*idantā*), then [one experiences] the state of the transmigrating individual (*saṃsāripuruṣa*).[81] This is [what the *Vṛtti*] says with "differentiated objects". And in that state, this I-realization [takes the form] "I, who am this [individual], know this [object] such as a pot and act upon it". [It] consists in a [conscious] manifestation that pervades an aspect [of reality] that merely [amounts

[80] Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 437: *śuddhim aśuddhiṃ ca vibhajati* ***śuddhatve'pī****ty* ***aśuddhihetutvād*** *iti ca. āropitam etad aśuddhatvaṃ na svābhāvikam ahantaikāntaviśrānteḥ.* "[Utpaladeva] distinguishes [the ways in which] purity and impurity [can be ascribed to that state by saying] 'even though it is pure…' and 'inasmuch as [this state]… is the cause of impurity'. This impurity is superimposed, it does not belong to the [very] nature [of that state], since [in it manifestation still] exclusively rests on subjectivity (*ahantā*)."

[81] Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 437: *evam ahantāyāḥ śuddhāśuddhatvaṃ vyākhyāyāśuddhatvaṃ vyācaṣṭe* ***saive****ti. nāsāv ahantānyāpi tu svaśaktivaicitryāt saivānena rūpāntareṇa bhāti tattvabhuvanabhāvabhūtaprabhṛtiṣv avabhāsabhāgeṣu. ābhāsabhedeṣu tāvad vastuto'sāv ahantā vyāpakatvenānuprāṇakatvena tāvadābhāsāntarbhāvanenāvatiṣṭhate. tat tathābhūtaṃ yad ahantayāvasthānaṃ tad yadedantāvamarśayogyatayā teṣām ābhāsane māyāśaktikṛtayā tirohitaṃ tadā sāhantādaśā saṃsāriṇām ucitā yogyā.* "Having thus explained the state of subjectivity that is [both] pure and impure, [Utpaladeva now] describes impurity with [the passage beginning with] *saiva*... [It is 'the same subjectivity', i.e.] this subjectivity is none other [than the one manifest in the states of Śiva and Īśvara]; nonetheless, due to the variety of its powers, this same [subjectivity] is manifest in this other form within the aspects of manifestation that are the ontological principles, worlds, objective and subjective [limited] entities, etc. To begin with, in fact this subjectivity exists in these various phenomena as what pervades them, [that is to say,] as what gives [them their very] life by internally imagining (*bhāvana*) all of these phenomena. So when the existence [of the universal consciousness] that is such, [i.e.] that [really occurs] in a [purely] subjective form, is concealed in the manifestation of these [phenomena] inasmuch as it becomes the object of a realization [that takes] an objective form [i.e. 'this' rather than 'I']—[an objectification] made [possible] through the power of *māyā* –, then this state of subjectivity is [the state] appropriate for the transmigrating subjects."

to] a differentiated apprehending subject who is dependent upon a differentiated apprehended object, [their differentiation being expressed] through a difference in the grammatical cases [of the words denoting them].[82] [This I-realization] also consists in action; [but in that state] this nature [of the I-realization as consisting of conscious manifestation and action] has disappeared,[83] because it arises while having as its property (*śarīra*)[84] the intellect and [other things with which individuals identify[85] and] which exist as differentiated, objective aspects. [In that form this I-realization] is called *sattva* and *rajas*, [and] due to the delimitation (*niyama*) [inherent] in the spatial and temporal separation [of all limited objects and subjects, the I-realization taking this inferior form] is [also] mixed with the *tamas* that penetrates [*sattva* and *rajas*;[86] and we] have explained that [this I-realization]

[82] Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 438: *evambhūtasyāhaṃvimarśasyākāraṃ darśayaty* ***aham ayam*** *ityādinā* ***karomi cetyantena****. nanv atra grāhyagrāhakayoḥ kathaṃ bhinnatā. āha* ***vaiyadhikaraṇyeneti****.* "[Utpaladeva now] shows the aspect taken on by such an I-realization in [the passage] beginning with 'I, who am this [individual]' and ending with 'and act upon it'. But how can the apprehended object and apprehending subject be differentiated? [Utpaladeva] answers [this question by saying] 'through a difference in the grammatical cases [of the words denoting them]'."

[83] Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, pp. 437-438: *ahaṃvimarśanasya svarūpaṃ darśayati, prakāśarūpaṃ kriyārūpañ ca bhavad api tathāśaktirūpatvāt pracyutam, tato jñānaṃ sattvavyapadeśyaṃ kriyā rajovyapadeśyā tatra ca madhye niyāmakaṃ tamaḥ praviṣṭam, tena guṇatrayamayam aham iti vimarśanaṃ jātam. svarūpapracyutau hetuḥ—bhinnam idambhāgāvasthitaṃ yad buddhiprāṇādi taccharīratayā taddharmatayā tad ahaṃvimarśanam utpannaṃ tata utpattihetoḥ pracyutasvarūpaṃ tat. tathotpattir asya kutaḥ. āha bhinnaṃ grāhyam apekṣamāṇaṃ tato grāhyād bhinnaṃ yad grāhakamātraṃ sa eva bhāgo'ṃśas* tam avagāhate yatas tasmād evam utpannam.* [**bhāgo'ṃśas* conj. : *bhāgāṃśas* ĪPVV.] "[Utpaladeva now] explains the nature of this I-realization [in the impure state]. Although [this nature] consists in [conscious] manifestation and action, because its nature is [precisely] such powers, [this nature] has disappeared, so that knowledge can be called *sattva*, action can be called *rajas*, and *tamas* penetrates them as that which limits (*niyāmaka*) them—so the I-realization becomes full of the three qualities (*guṇa*). [And here is] the reason for the disappearance of this nature: this I-realization arises as having as its 'body' (*śarīra*)—[which means here] its property (*dharma*)—the intellect, vital breath and [other things with which individuals identify and] which exist as objective aspects that are differentiated; the nature [of the I-realization] disappears precisely for the reason that is this arising. [But] why does it arise in this way? [Utpaladeva] answers: it arises thus because it pervades the aspect, [i.e.] the part (*aṃśa*) which is only an apprehending subject differentiated from an apprehended object and dependent on that differentiated apprehended object."

[84] According to Abhinavagupta's commentary (see ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 438, quoted below, fn. 83), which glosses *taccharīratayā—taddharmatayā.*

[85] The list that Utpaladeva has in mind here comprises the body (*deha*), vital breath (*prāṇa*), intellect (*buddhi*) and void (*śūnya*), in accordance with the typology of limited subjects given in ĪPK 1.6.4-5 (see Torella 2002, pp. 131–132, and Ratié 2011, pp. 204–208).

[86] On *tamas* as a limited equivalent, for the empirical individual, of Śiva's power of *māyā*, see ĪPK 4.3-4, translated in Torella 2002, pp. 211–212; on the definition of *tamas* as restriction or delimitation (*niyama*/*niyamana*), see e.g. ĪPV, vol. II, p. 255, explaining that the bound subject (*paśu*) possesses "*sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas*, which are [respectively] characterized by pleasure, pain and delusion, [and] which [respectively] function as [conscious] manifestation, action and delimitation" (*sukhaduḥkhamohalakṣaṇāni prakāśakriyāniyamanaśīlāni sattvarajastamāṃsi*).

has the nature of the knowledge and action that belong to the individual who consists in the non-recognition of [himself as] the Lord.[87]

And in all of these three states, everything is nothing but the I-realization—[this] has been repeated [in the Vṛtti] in order to describe the knowledge and action that are [both] pure and impure, so as to explain that this nature of knowledge and action is pure in all [cases];[88] and these very states—the pure, etc.—will be [further] explained [later in the treatise].[89] Thus [ends] the *Part on Knowledge*.

[87] Cf. ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 438: ... *aiśvaryasya nijasya yad apratyabhijñānaṃ tad eva prakṛtaṃ rūpaṃ yasya saṅkucitasaṃvillakṣaṇasya sa puruṣaḥ. tatsambandhinyau ye jñānakriye tatsvabhāvaṃ tad ahaṃvimarśanam.* "The individual is the [person] characterized by a contracted consciousness, whose nature—which is the topic discussed here—is nothing but the non-recognition of his own sovereignty; the I-realization has the nature of the knowledge and action belonging to this [individual]."

[88] I am not sure whether my interpretation here is correct (see above, fn. 60); anyway Abhinavagupta specifies that this remark concerns the Vṛtti." "insert this sentence SeeĪPVV, vol. II, p. 438: anūditamiti Vṛttittau." In any case, from Utpaladeva's *Vivṛti* and Abhinavagupta's commentary thereon it seems clear that in the *Vṛtti*, the words *ahaṃvimarśanam eva* are not only meant as attributes for "the pure knowledge and action" (*śuddhe jñānakriye*), but also for the "pure-and-impure" (*śuddhāśuddhe*) and the "absolutely impure" (*aśuddha eva*) knowledge and action (and I have translated the *Vṛtti* accordingly above, fn. 33). In other words, the main idea here is that *at all three levels, knowledge and action are manifestations of the I-realization* (or, as the *Vivṛti* puts it, it is "the same subjectivity", *saiva…ahantā*, that appears in these various forms).

[89] According to Abhinavagupta, this last sentence points out that Utpaladeva is not abandoning the distinction found in Śaiva scriptures between the three levels, and that although he insists on the fact that they are ultimately nothing but manifestations of the highest subjectivity, he does acknowledge the differences between them. See ĪPVV, vol. II, p. 439: *nanu trividhaṃ sad ahaṃvimarśanam uktaṃ śuddhādibhedena, tatrāgamasiddhaṃ paravyāmiśrāparalakṣaṇaṃ daśāntaratritayaṃ kiṃ tyaktam eva. na tyaktaṃ saṅgṛhītam evety āh**aitā eva ce**ti. **vakṣyanta** ity atrāparatvaṃ bhāvānām iti sūtreṇa.* "[– Objection:] But this I-realization, insofar as it is threefold, has been said to be differentiated according to whether it is pure, [both pure and impure, or impure]; in that regard, why are the three different states, which are scripturally established, and which are characterized as superior, mixed and inferior, simply abandoned [by Utpaladeva]? [– Answer]: they are not abandoned, on the contrary they are adopted: this is what Utpaladeva points out [by stating] 'and these very [states]'. 'They will be [further] explained'—[i.e.] in verse [3.1.5 beginning with] *atrāparatvaṃ bhāvānām…*" See ĪPK 3.1.5 (which connects this distinction between the three types of I-realization with the scale of the *tattva*s): *atrāparatvaṃ bhāvānām anātmatvena bhāsanāt | paratāhantayācchādāt parāparadaśā hi sā ||* "Here there is an inferior state (*aparatva*), because [objective] entities are manifested as not being the Self; [and yet] it is a superior state (*paratā*) since [these objective entities] are encompassed by subjectivity—for this is the state that is [both] superior and inferior." According to ĪPV, vol. II, p. 199 and ĪPVV, vol. III, p. 274, "here" (*atra*) refers to the "two ontological principles" (*tattvadvaya*) of Sadāśiva and Īśvara (cf. *Bhāskarī*, vol. II, p. 227: *tattvadvaya iti sadāśivarūpa īśvararūpe cety arthaḥ*).

## Appendix: Extent of the Pratyabhijñā Treatise Covered by the *Vivṛti* Codex Unicus, the Fragments from ĪPV Manuscripts and the ĪPVV Annotated Manuscript

| Verses in the treatise | Part 1 | Part 2 | Part 3 | Part 4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Chap. 1 | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 | **1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8** | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11 | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18 |
| Chap. 2 | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11 | **1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7** | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20 | |
| Chap. 3 | 1, 2, 3, 4, **5, 6, 7** | **1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8**, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17 | | |
| Chap. 4 | **1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8,** | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21 | | |
| Chap. 5 | **1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9**, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21 | | | |
| Chap. 6 | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11 | | | |
| Chap. 7 | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14 | | | |
| Chap. 8 | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, **10, 11** | | | |

Verses covered by the *Vivṛti* codex unicus

Verses covered (with lacunae) by the fragments thus far edited from marginal annotations in ĪPV manuscripts

Verses covered by the fragment in the margins of ĪPVV manuscript J11

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